

ESSAY QUESTION

Read the scenario carefully and use it to answer each question appropriately.

Mr. M. C. K Meveh, a 95 year-old man, a retired Headmaster of Obuoba Secondary Technical in Humdzibre. He complained of not seeing well. He complains almost always of feeling cold irrespective of the weather. He finds it difficult to walk straight.

Question One

What name is given to this level of ageing? Explain briefly why Mr. Meveh is not able to see well to a Level 100 student linking your explanation to the effect of ageing on the car.
6Marks

Question Two

Mr. Meveh's ageing has aspects to his condition as

- a. Intrinsic
- b. Extrinsic

Explain each of them with examples

ANSWER

Question One

Name given to this level of ageing

This level of ageing is called Very old age / Advanced old age (old–old age).

Explanation:

Old age is commonly classified as:

Young old: 60–74 years

Middle old: 75–84 years

Very old (old–old): 85 years and above

Since Mr. Meveh is 95 years old, he falls into the very old age group.

Why Mr. Meveh is not able to see well (linked to ageing and the car analogy)

As people age, degenerative changes occur in the eyes, leading to poor vision.

The lens of the eye becomes stiff and cloudy (conditions such as presbyopia and cataract).

The pupil becomes smaller, allowing less light to enter.

The retina becomes less sensitive to light.

Car analogy:

The eye can be compared to a car headlamp and windscreen:

In a new car, the headlights are bright and the windscreen is clear.

In an old car, the headlights become dim and the windscreen becomes cloudy or scratched.

Similarly, in old age, the eye's "headlamp" (lens and retina) becomes weak and cloudy, making it difficult for Mr. Meveh to see clearly.

Question Two

a. Intrinsic ageing

Explanation:

Intrinsic ageing refers to natural, internal ageing processes that occur due to genetics and the passage of time. It cannot be prevented.

Examples in Mr. Meveh:

Poor vision due to ageing changes in the eyes

Feeling cold easily due to reduced metabolism

Difficulty walking straight due to reduced muscle strength and balance

b. Extrinsic ageing

Explanation:

Extrinsic ageing refers to ageing caused by external factors from the environment and lifestyle.

Examples:

Long-term exposure to sunlight

Poor nutrition over the years

Lack of physical activity

Occupational stress during his working years as a headmaster